

Ethics Essay

Ethics and morality are critical parts of our society. They help us navigate through many situations even when we aren't actively thinking about them. A "Code of Ethics" is one way to promote ethical decision making. It is a set of guidelines that outlines expectations of behavior in day to day life. The purpose of having a Code of Ethics is to establish a set of principles that individuals can utilize when faced with ethical situations. By adhering to this Code of Ethics, individuals can make decisions that consider the potential impact on others. When faced with an ethical situation, my personal decision making process starts with my personal feelings on the matter, where I assess whether or not those can be problematic. I then think of ideal ethical principles (Code of Ethics) and what those would tell me to do in the given situation. These can also help me assess any potential consequences of my actions. Furthermore, I also take into account the effects on other people that are involved.

During my class discussions on ethics, several ethical issues were explored. These included topics such as racial issues, professional integrity, privacy and data collection and many other topics. In particular, one case that I read about was an issue where Amazon might have had audio recordings from an Amazon Echo of a crime that took place and were faced with an ethical issue of whether or not to turn in that evidence to the police. This brings forth the virtues of Integrity, Honesty, Responsibility and Self-Discipline. The virtues of Integrity and Honesty were brought forth, as they thought about the consumers' safety as a whole and how this would affect their customers' trust with the company. Responsibility and Self-Discipline were brought forth as a large company such as Amazon had to show restraint by considering the consequences of their potential actions of turning in evidence to the police and losing the trust of their consumer base. Although this decision might have partially come out of wanting to save their own skin, their actions there benefitted the majority.

The outcome of these lessons were similar to my own ideals in that they emphasized the importance of considering the consequences of my actions. However, there were also some differences. For example, in class discussions, different perspectives and viewpoints were brought forward, which allowed me to think about different perspectives on issues where I might have thought my point of view was correct. Despite any differences, our discussion group was usually able to come to a consensus on what the most "ethical" decision would be in each situation. Ethics and morals are the guiding principles that controls our behavior. The purpose of having and following a "Code of Ethics" is to provide a set of principles that govern the behavior of people in order to ensure professionalism and fairness to all parties involved.